Good numbers. I did not know him that well, but one line in his retirement speech – ‘it’s been a love–hate relationship with the sport in retrospect’ – will have resonated with many cricketers. It reminded me of a conversation we had, playing together for MCC in a T20 tournament in Dubai in March 2015. He congratulated me for having recently passed 10,000 Test runs.

‘You’re going to go down in the record books as a legend of cricket,’ he told me, out of the blue.

It’s difficult to know what to say to that. Half-jokingly, I replied, ‘You’re laughing all the way to the bank.’

His response was instant: ‘I’ll swap it all, to have your Test career.’

The finality of the statement took me back. He didn’t qualify it by saying he would swap an awful lot to have my set of numbers. He was all-in. His comment wasn’t really about me. It was a reflection on the status of the most traditional form of the game, by a player whose wealth and reputation were formed during the IPL revolution.

Yuvraj won the IPL twice. His final achievement was to help Mumbai Indians become champions in 2019. I’ve never played in that tournament, never experienced its fireworks and fervour, though I have an inkling what it would feel like, because of the amazing atmosphere generated in India by one-day internationals.

Call me short sighted, but I didn’t immediately recognize the importance of the IPL. I didn’t see it transforming cricket, in micro time, as it has. I was wrong. I may look back and wonder whether I could have changed my game to fit the franchise format, but it is not a matter of enduring regret. Test cricket was ingrained in me from childhood.

The skill factor in modern T20 cricket is extraordinary. Barriers have been broken down. Things that were once considered impossible are now commonplace. The game has changed beyond recognition. In the land of the high-stakes shootout, the gambler is king. The contrast to the early days of one-day cricket is like comparing a Model-T Ford with a Bugatti Veyron.

When the sixty-over World Cup was brought in (the number of overs was reduced to fifty in 1987), there seemed little point in chasing 260 to win. That sort of challenge intimidated teams, who would have a glorified net in reply. As the game evolved, we were taught to hit pockets. Graham Gooch was a pioneer. Mark Ramprakash mastered the shot over extra cover for two or four. It required skill and nerve, but there was a decent margin for error.